GSA-FSS
AMENDMENT-4
March 1, 1971
SUPERSEDING
Amendment-3
January 29, 1968

AMENDMENT

TO

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

SHEARS AND SCISSORS

This Amendment was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D. C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. The General Services Administration has authorized this Amendment as a part of Interim Federal Specification GSA-FSS dated June 16, 1964.

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Paragraph 3.9.4, delete entire paragraph and substitute:

3.9.4 Type I, class 4, tailors' (pattern). The tip end of the blade having the thumb ring shall be pointed, and the tip of the other blade shall be either bevelled or blunted. The finger ring shall provide a protrusion suitable for use as a table rest, and the thumb ring shall provide a handle stop. In addition, the thumb ring and adjacent handle area shall be shaped so that when the thumb is inserted as far into the ring as possible, there shall be a smooth contoured ledge provided to support at least 3/4 of the entire length of the thumb. Class 4 shears shall meet the material requirements of 3.9.1.1, shall conform to table V, and be similar to figure 5.

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Paragraph 3.10.6, delete entire paragraph and substitute:

3.10.6 Type II, class 6, electricians. Class 6, electricians' scissors shall be designed with both blades pointed and shall have dulled, serrated scraping edges on backs of the blades. Class 6 scissors shall conform to table III and be similar to figures 12 and 12A.

3.10.6.1 Material. Scissors shall be hot forged from steel complying with one of the following.

(a) High carbon steel, fine grain practice, having a minimum carbon content of 0.70 percent, maximum phosphorus content of 0.025 percent, and maximum sulphur content of 0.025 percent.

(b) Alloy steel, fine grain practice, with a minimum carbon content of 0.60 percent and a minimum total of alloying elements excluding manganese of 0.20 percent. Phosphorus maximum shall be 0.025 percent and sulphur maximum 0.025 percent.

(c) Alloy steel, fine grain practice, with a minimum carbon content of 0.48 percent and a minimum total of alloy elements excluding manganese of 0.95 percent. Phosphorus maximum shall be 0.025 percent and sulphur maximum 0.025 percent.

3.10.6.2 Blade hardness. Blades shall have a hardness on the Rockwell "C" scale of not less than 55 nor more than 61 (see 4.4.2.1). Matching areas anywhere on the blades of a pair of scissors shall be within two points hardness.

3.10.6.3 Blade joining. Blades shall be joined by a steel screw which shall require a torque of not less than 10 inch-pounds to loosen (see 4.5.1.5.4).

3.10.6.4 Finish. Scissors shall be smoothly and fully finished with no rough or irregular edges. All surfaces shall be plated except the cutting edges and the insides of the blades. The insides of the blades shall be smoothly ground and polished at an angle of 60° to 85° from the edge. The micro inch finish shall be 15 maximum, arithmetic average. A brush finish shall not be acceptable. Edges shall be ground after plating to an angle of 25° ± 5°, measured from a plane of 90° to the inside of the blades.

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Delete table XII and substitute the following:

TABLE XII. Type II, class 6, electricians' scissors

Overall Length		Minimum length of cut	Minimum weight per dozen
Nominal	Actual		
Inches	Inches	Inches	Pounds
5	5-1/8 $^{+1/8}_{-0}$	1-3/4	1-1/2

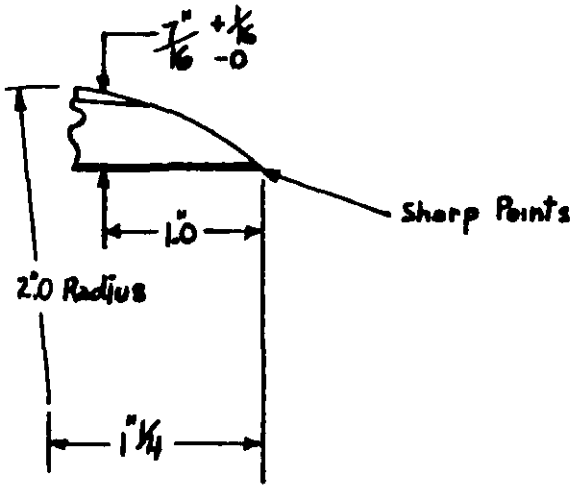


FIGURE 12A. Point configuration.

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Paragraph 4.3, line 3: Delete "and" and add "and 3.10.6.1" to the end of the sentence.

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Paragraph 4.4.2.1, line 2: Delete "and" and add "and 3.10.6.2" to the end of the sentence.

Paragraph 4.5.1.1.3, after "(1)" and "(2)" add the following:

"(3) Using only the extreme end of the cutting blades, beginning one inch from the point of the blades."

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Paragraph 4.5.1.1.4: Delete the table and substitute:

	Length (in inches)				
	Up to 6	6 to 8	9	10	Over 10
Type I, class 1, design 1	—	—	3	3	4
Type I, class 1, design 2 class 2	—	6	8	12	14
Type II, all scissors except class 6	4	—	—	—	—

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Delete paragraph 4.5.1.5 and substitute the following:

4.5.1.5 Tests for type II, class 6, electricians' scissors.

4.5.1.5.1 Cotton shooting cutting test. Each sample scissors shall be submitted to hand cutting tests using cotton shooting, plain weave, 56 x 60 threads per inch and 3.8 ounces per square yard. This test material shall be cut cleanly, without drag or pull, and shall fall freely away from the cutting edges, including the points.

4.5.1.5.2 Aluminum oxide cutting test. Each sample scissors shall be required to make a total of 150 cuts in 150 grit aluminum oxide single-faced abrasive cloth. After every 25 cuts, the scissors shall be tested for cutting one thickness of 3.8 ounce cotton shooting (see 4.5.1.5.1). During the next 25 cuts, the opposite blade shall face the abrasive side of the aluminum oxide cloth. Failure to cut the 3.8 ounce cotton cloth cleanly for at least 3/4 of the length of the blade, measured from the tips, shall be cause for rejection. The tests requiring 25 cuts in the aluminum oxide described above shall be performed by hand; however, after every 25 cuts (by hand) the tests for cutting one thickness of 3.8 ounce cotton shooting (see 4.5.1.5.1) shall be performed on a testing machine like or similar to that shown in figure 13 and described in paragraph 4.5.1.5.2.1.

4.5.1.5.2.1 Scissors testing machine. The testing machine shall be designed to clamp the screw that joins the scissors between two pins, and retain one blade in the horizontal position by holding the thumb loop on a fixed mandrel. The finger loop of the other blade shall be positioned on a movable mandrel which shall be actuated by a variable speed motor through a mechanical linkage system. The speed of the motor shall produce 75 ± 10 percent cuts per minute. The mechanical linkage system shall force the movable blade fully open (not to exceed 90° included angle) and then fully close the scissors (so that points meet or overlap slightly) in each cutting cycle (see figure 13). A string or light cable shall be attached, as indicated in the figure, to the end of the finger loop of the movable blade, and a 100 gram weight shall be attached to the other end. The cable and weight shall be positioned over a pulley located three feet from, and on the center line of the screw that joins the scissors so that the 100 gram weight acts in the direction to pull the two blades together assimilating side thrust.

4.5.1.5.3 Wire cutting test. Using a sample scissors not already tested in 4.5.1.5.2 take 20 cuts through wire consisting of 10 strands of copper, .036 (0.0050) AWG or heavier. The scissors under test shall cleanly cut the wire without any assistance such as bending, or pulling, or twisting of the wire by the operator. There shall be no visible deformation or damage to the cutting edges of the scissors.

4.5.1.5.4 Screw torque test. Each sample electricians' scissors shall be tested for "back off" torque put on the joining screw. A torque screwdriver or a torque wrench with a screwdriver attachment shall be used, and the joining screw shall withstand a torque of 10 inch-pounds without backing off.

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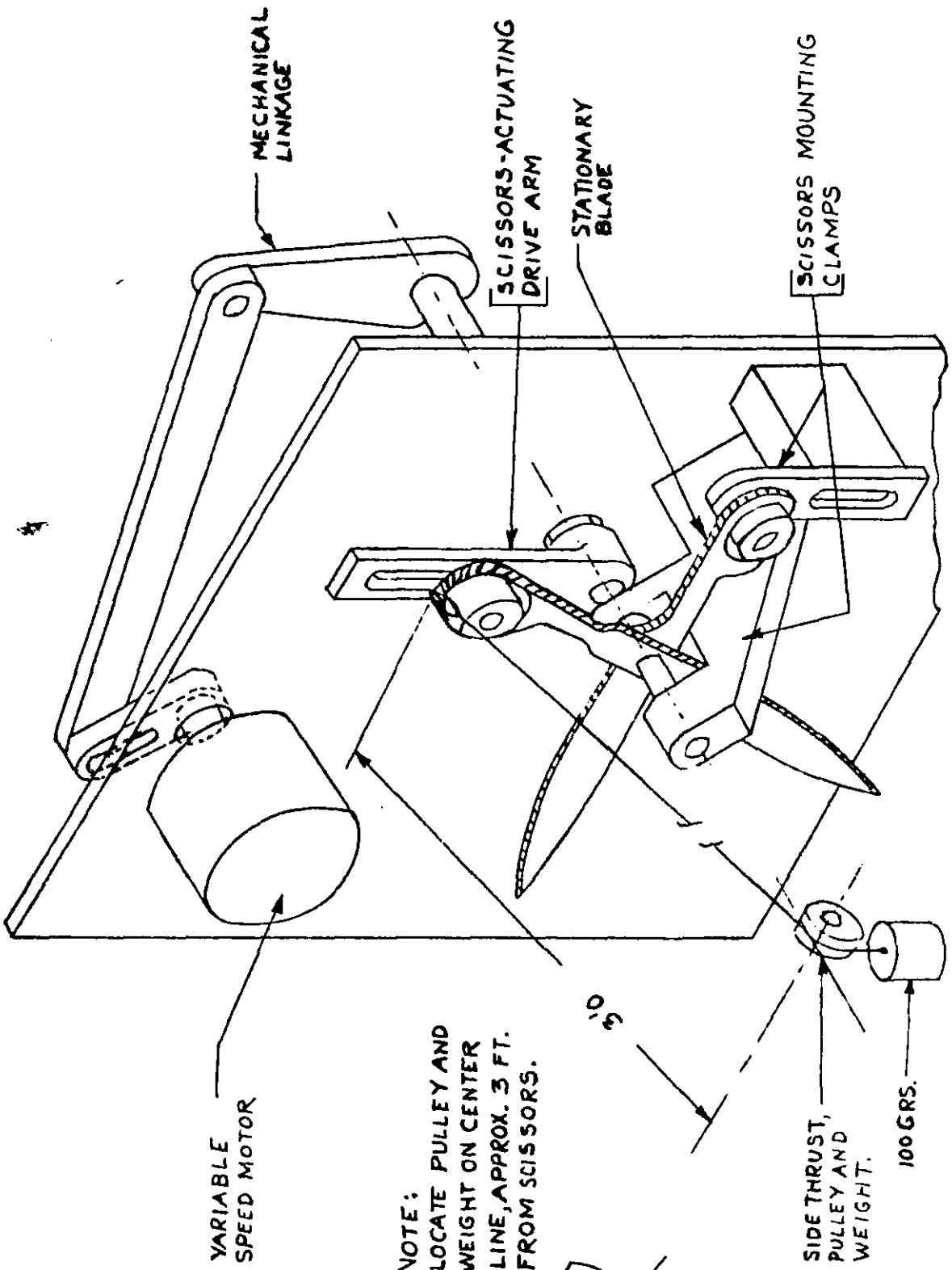


FIGURE 13. Scissors testing machine.

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